

Coral reefs

Even though coral reefs cover less than 1 percent of our oceans, they are home to 25 percent of all ocean life! These huge rocky structures grow gradually from the skeletons of tiny sea creatures. Animals and plants find shelter and safety here, turning reefs into underwater worlds of spectacular color.

Great Barrier Reef

Australia's Great Barrier Reef started growing about 8,000 years ago. Today, it is the world's largest reef, covering 132,900 sq miles (344,400 sq km) and it is even visible from space.